

A PERSONAL COACHING GUIDE

THE 100-DAY TRANSFORMATION

Run a Marathon. Build Muscle. Stay Athletic.

SHIVAM

Age 26 | Height 181 cm | Weight 83 kg | Body Fat 23.5%

100 Days

DURATION

29 Jun 2026

START

6 Oct 2026

RACE DAY

THREE THINGS THIS PLAN BALANCES, EVERY SINGLE DAY

1

RUN

0 -> 42.2 km, gradually

2

LIFT

Push / Pull / Legs split

3

RECOVER

Sleep, food, mobility

*"The goal isn't a skinny finisher's medal."
It's a strong, muscular one.*

29 Jun 2026 to 6 Oct 2026

Prepared for Shivam - 100 Days - Run / Lift / Recover

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PART 1 THE PLAN

1. Welcome to Your 100 Days

This guide is built around one fact: you are not a typical first-time marathoner, and you shouldn't train like one. You currently run about 2 km with real effort, you lift in a full commercial gym, and your goal isn't just to finish a marathon - it's to finish it carrying visible muscle, not as a depleted, skinny runner. That changes almost every decision in this plan: how fast mileage builds, how the gym split is arranged around long runs, and how much you eat.

Three principles run through everything that follows. First, consistency beats intensity - showing up for an easy 4 km run does more for you over 100 days than one heroic 12 km run followed by two weeks of an injured ankle. Second, the long run is the priority of the week; the gym plan is built to protect it, not compete with it. Third, this plan is honest with you about risk: a marathon in 100 days from a 2 km starting point is ambitious, and Part 5 includes a clear decision point around Week 13 to confirm whether you go for the full 42.2 km or a half marathon instead. Either outcome is a genuine win.

How to use this guide

Part 2 is your day-by-day calendar - check it every morning. Part 3 is your gym program in full detail. Part 4 is food: macros, meal plans, recipes and a shopping list. Part 5 covers recovery, injury prevention and race day. Part 6 has printable trackers and four milestone check-ins (Day 25/50/75/100).

2. Your Starting Point

Age	26	Height	181 cm
Weight	83 kg	Body fat	~23.5%
Current running	~2 km, 9-10 min, significant effort	Gym access	Full commercial gym
Work hours	10:00 AM - 6:00 PM	Diet	No beef; vegetarian (no eggs) Tue & Wed

The physique target - not just a finish line

Instead of chasing the lowest possible body-fat number, we are aiming for an athletic recomposition: broader shoulders, a fuller chest, defined arms, strong legs, visible upper abs when flexing, and real endurance - while staying around 80-82 kg rather than dropping into 'skinny-runner' territory.

Target	Detail
Weight	80-82 kg
Body fat	~18-20%
Look	Broad shoulders, fuller chest, defined arms
Engine	Marathon (or half-marathon) finisher, run/walk strategy if needed

3. Training Philosophy

Why this isn't a standard marathon plan

Standard marathon plans assume you're optimising for one thing: speed over 42.2 km. They often cut gym work to almost nothing in the final month to save your legs. You're optimising for two things at once - a finished marathon and a muscular frame - so this plan keeps heavy lifting through most of the program and only pulls volume back in the final peak/taper phase, when long runs get genuinely long.

The run/walk method

From a 2 km base, the fastest way to injury is running every metre at a hard effort. Every 'easy' and 'long' run in this plan can include walk breaks - especially in the first four weeks and again whenever a long run crosses new distance territory. Walking is not failure; it is the technique that lets first-time marathoners both finish and stay uninjured.

The 10% rule, bent on purpose

Classic advice caps weekly mileage growth at ~10%. Your 100-day timeline doesn't allow for that everywhere, so the early weeks (where the body adapts fastest and injury risk per kilometre is lowest) progress a bit faster, while the back half - where long runs get into double digits and real impact accumulates - progresses more conservatively and includes a cutback week (Week 13) before the final taper.

Listen to your body - non-negotiable

Mild general tiredness and muscle soreness are normal. Sharp, one-sided, or joint-specific pain that changes how you walk is not. If that happens, stop, rest 2-3 days, and see a doctor or physiotherapist before resuming - pushing through it is how a 2-week niggle becomes a 2-month injury that ends the marathon attempt.

4. Your Daily Schedule

Weekday template (Monday-Friday)

Time	Activity
5:15 AM	Wake up - drink 500 mL water
5:30-6:30 AM	Run (per the daily plan, Part 2)
6:30-6:45 AM	Stretch & cool down
6:45-7:15 AM	Shower
7:15-7:40 AM	High-protein breakfast
8:00-9:15 AM	Relax, get ready, commute
10:00 AM-6:00 PM	Work
6:45-8:00 PM	Gym (per the daily plan, Part 3)
8:15 PM	Dinner
9:00 PM	10-min light walk; prep for tomorrow
9:45 PM	Wind down, screens off
10:00 PM	Lights out (target 7.5-8 hrs sleep)

Weekend adjustment

Saturday morning is your long run - give it the time it needs rather than squeezing it before work; there is no gym lifting Saturday evening, just stretching so your body banks the adaptation. Sunday is a full rest day or an easy 30-minute walk, plus mobility work - no running, no lifting.

5. The Weekly Training Split

Day	Morning (Run)	Evening (Gym)
Monday	Easy run	Push (Heavy) - Chest/Shoulders/Triceps
Tuesday	Speed/Interval run	Pull (Heavy) - Back/Biceps
Wednesday	Recovery run (short, easy)	Legs (Moderate)
Thursday	Tempo run	Upper Body Hypertrophy + Core
Friday	Easy run	Full Body + Core (lighter)
Saturday	Long run	Mobility / stretch only - no lifting
Sunday	Rest or 30-min walk	Mobility, stretching, recovery

This split repeats every week for 100 days. What changes week to week is the distance and intensity of each run (Part 2) and, in the back half of the program, the volume of the lifting sessions (Part 3) as long runs get longer. Exact exercises for each gym day are detailed in Part 3.

PART 2 TRAINING - THE 100-DAY RUNNING PLAN

6. The Big Picture

Fourteen weeks of progressive building, then two final taper days before race day. Every week follows the same rhythm - easy, speed, recovery, tempo, easy, long, rest - so the only thing that changes is the distance. The table below is your at-a-glance progression; Part 2.2 walks through each phase in more depth, and Section 8 gives you the complete day-by-day calendar with real dates.

Week	Phase	Easy run	Saturday long run
1	Foundation	Easy run/walk	Long run/walk - 3 km
2	Foundation	Easy	Long run - 4 km
3	Base Building	Easy	Long run - 5 km
4	Base Building	Easy	Long run - 7 km
5	Endurance	Easy	Long run - 8 km
6	Endurance	Easy	Long run - 10 km
7	Endurance	Easy	Long run - 12 km
8	Endurance	Easy	Long run - 14 km
9	Distance	Easy	Long run - 16 km
10	Distance	Easy	Long run - 18 km
11	Distance	Easy	Long run - 20 km
12	Distance	Easy	Long run - 22 km
13	Peak	Easy	Long run - 26 km
14	Taper	Easy	Long run (taper) - 16 km

Final two days (99-100): light jog or rest, then race day.

7. Phase by Phase

Phase 1 - Foundation (Weeks 1-2)

Goal: prove to your joints and connective tissue that running is a normal, repeated activity - not a one-off. Every run can be run/walk; pace is irrelevant. Expect your 2 km to start feeling noticeably easier by the end of Week 2.

Common mistake

Running every metre because walking 'feels like cheating'. It isn't - it's the technique that lets you train again tomorrow.

Phase 2 - Base Building (Weeks 3-4)

Goal: introduce a little structure - light intervals to improve speed and economy, and a first real tempo run (a 'comfortably hard' steady effort, not a sprint). The Saturday long run crosses 5 km for the first time in Week 4 - a genuine milestone from a 2 km start.

Phase 3 - Endurance (Weeks 5-8)

Goal: build a real aerobic engine. Long runs move from 8 km to 14 km. This is where most of your cardiovascular fitness is built, and where good shoes, a stable running surface, and the stretching routine in Part 5 start to matter a lot more.

Fuel the long run

Once a long run passes ~9-10 km, take water with you, and start practising race-day fuelling (Part 5) on a couple of these runs - don't leave it until the race.

Phase 4 - Distance (Weeks 9-12)

Goal: push toward half-marathon-plus territory. Long runs go from 16 km to 22 km. Leg-day gym volume comes down from Week 9 (see the note on that week's calendar) so your legs can absorb both. This phase is the real test of whether the full marathon is realistic for race day.

Phase 5 - Peak & Taper (Weeks 13-14 + final days)

Week 13 carries your longest run of the whole program (26 km) and is also your decision point - see Part 5, Section 14 for exactly how to use that run to choose between the full marathon and the half marathon. Week 14 tapers mileage down hard while keeping you moving, so you arrive at the start line recovered, not flat.

8. The Complete 100-Day Calendar

Every day, mapped to a real date starting 29 Jun 2026. "Easy", "Recovery" and "Long run" paces should all feel conversational, especially in the first half of the program - speed is not the point yet.

WEEK 1 FOUNDATION		29 Jun 2026 - 5 Jul 2026	
Day	Date	Morning Run	Evening Gym
Day 1 - Mon	29 Jun 2026	Easy run/walk - 2 km	Push (Heavy) Chest/Shoulders/Tri
Day 2 - Tue	30 Jun 2026	Intervals: 8x(1min run/2min walk), ~2 km	Pull (Heavy) Back/Biceps
Day 3 - Wed	1 Jul 2026	Recovery jog/walk - 2 km	Legs (Moderate)
Day 4 - Thu	2 Jul 2026	Easy run/walk - 2 km	Upper Hypertrophy + Core
Day 5 - Fri	3 Jul 2026	Easy run/walk - 2.5 km	Full Body + Core (lighter)
Day 6 - Sat	4 Jul 2026	Long run/walk - 3 km	Mobility / Stretch (no lifting)
Day 7 - Sun	5 Jul 2026	Rest or 20-min walk	Mobility + Recovery walk

WEEK 2 FOUNDATION		6 Jul 2026 - 12 Jul 2026	
Day	Date	Morning Run	Evening Gym
Day 8 - Mon	6 Jul 2026	Easy - 3 km	Push (Heavy) Chest/Shoulders/Tri
Day 9 - Tue	7 Jul 2026	Intervals: 5x400m fast/400m slow, ~3.5 km	Pull (Heavy) Back/Biceps
Day 10 - Wed	8 Jul 2026	Recovery - 2.5 km	Legs (Moderate)
Day 11 - Thu	9 Jul 2026	Easy - 3 km	Upper Hypertrophy + Core
Day 12 - Fri	10 Jul 2026	Easy - 3 km	Full Body + Core (lighter)
Day 13 - Sat	11 Jul 2026	Long run - 4 km	Mobility / Stretch (no lifting)
Day 14 - Sun	12 Jul 2026	Rest or 25-min walk	Mobility + Recovery walk

WEEK 3		BASE BUILDING		13 Jul 2026 - 19 Jul 2026	
Day	Date	Morning Run		Evening Gym	
Day 15 - Mon	13 Jul 2026	Easy - 4 km		Push (Heavy) Chest/Shoulders/Tri	
Day 16 - Tue	14 Jul 2026	Intervals: 6x400m, ~4 km		Pull (Heavy) Back/Biceps	
Day 17 - Wed	15 Jul 2026	Recovery - 3 km		Legs (Moderate)	
Day 18 - Thu	16 Jul 2026	Tempo - 3 km steady		Upper Hypertrophy + Core	
Day 19 - Fri	17 Jul 2026	Easy - 4 km		Full Body + Core (lighter)	
Day 20 - Sat	18 Jul 2026	Long run - 5 km		Mobility / Stretch (no lifting)	
Day 21 - Sun	19 Jul 2026	Rest or 30-min walk		Mobility + Recovery walk	

WEEK 4		BASE BUILDING		20 Jul 2026 - 26 Jul 2026	
Day	Date	Morning Run		Evening Gym	
Day 22 - Mon	20 Jul 2026	Easy - 5 km		Push (Heavy) Chest/Shoulders/Tri	
Day 23 - Tue	21 Jul 2026	Intervals: 6x400m + 2x800m, ~5 km		Pull (Heavy) Back/Biceps	
Day 24 - Wed	22 Jul 2026	Recovery - 3 km		Legs (Moderate)	
Day 25 - Thu	23 Jul 2026	Tempo - 4 km		Upper Hypertrophy + Core	
Day 26 - Fri	24 Jul 2026	Easy - 5 km		Full Body + Core (lighter)	
Day 27 - Sat	25 Jul 2026	Long run - 7 km		Mobility / Stretch (no lifting)	
Day 28 - Sun	26 Jul 2026	Rest or 30-min walk		Mobility + Recovery walk	

Coach's note

Milestone: first run past 5 km.

WEEK 5		ENDURANCE	27 Jul 2026 - 2 Aug 2026	
Day	Date	Morning Run	Evening Gym	
Day 29 - Mon	27 Jul 2026	Easy - 5 km	Push (Heavy) Chest/Shoulders/Tri	
Day 30 - Tue	28 Jul 2026	Intervals: 5x800m, ~5 km	Pull (Heavy) Back/Biceps	
Day 31 - Wed	29 Jul 2026	Recovery - 4 km	Legs (Moderate)	
Day 32 - Thu	30 Jul 2026	Tempo - 4 km	Upper Hypertrophy + Core	
Day 33 - Fri	31 Jul 2026	Easy - 6 km	Full Body + Core (lighter)	
Day 34 - Sat	1 Aug 2026	Long run - 8 km	Mobility / Stretch (no lifting)	
Day 35 - Sun	2 Aug 2026	Rest or 30-min walk	Mobility + Recovery walk	

WEEK 6		ENDURANCE	3 Aug 2026 - 9 Aug 2026	
Day	Date	Morning Run	Evening Gym	
Day 36 - Mon	3 Aug 2026	Easy - 6 km	Push (Heavy) Chest/Shoulders/Tri	
Day 37 - Tue	4 Aug 2026	Intervals: 4x1 km, ~6 km	Pull (Heavy) Back/Biceps	
Day 38 - Wed	5 Aug 2026	Recovery - 4 km	Legs (Moderate)	
Day 39 - Thu	6 Aug 2026	Tempo - 5 km	Upper Hypertrophy + Core	
Day 40 - Fri	7 Aug 2026	Easy - 6 km	Full Body + Core (lighter)	
Day 41 - Sat	8 Aug 2026	Long run - 10 km	Mobility / Stretch (no lifting)	
Day 42 - Sun	9 Aug 2026	Rest or 30-min walk	Mobility + Recovery walk	

Coach's note

Milestone: first double-digit long run.

WEEK 7		ENDURANCE	10 Aug 2026 - 16 Aug 2026	
Day	Date	Morning Run	Evening Gym	
Day 43 - Mon	10 Aug 2026	Easy - 7 km	Push (Heavy) Chest/Shoulders/Tri	
Day 44 - Tue	11 Aug 2026	Steady run - 6 km	Pull (Heavy) Back/Biceps	
Day 45 - Wed	12 Aug 2026	Recovery - 4-5 km	Legs (Moderate)	
Day 46 - Thu	13 Aug 2026	Tempo - 5 km	Upper Hypertrophy + Core	
Day 47 - Fri	14 Aug 2026	Easy - 7 km	Full Body + Core (lighter)	
Day 48 - Sat	15 Aug 2026	Long run - 12 km	Mobility / Stretch (no lifting)	
Day 49 - Sun	16 Aug 2026	Rest or 30-min walk	Mobility + Recovery walk	

WEEK 8		ENDURANCE	17 Aug 2026 - 23 Aug 2026	
Day	Date	Morning Run	Evening Gym	
Day 50 - Mon	17 Aug 2026	Easy - 8 km	Push (Heavy) Chest/Shoulders/Tri	
Day 51 - Tue	18 Aug 2026	Steady run - 7 km	Pull (Heavy) Back/Biceps	
Day 52 - Wed	19 Aug 2026	Recovery - 5 km	Legs (Moderate)	
Day 53 - Thu	20 Aug 2026	Tempo - 6 km	Upper Hypertrophy + Core	
Day 54 - Fri	21 Aug 2026	Easy - 8 km	Full Body + Core (lighter)	
Day 55 - Sat	22 Aug 2026	Long run - 14 km	Mobility / Stretch (no lifting)	
Day 56 - Sun	23 Aug 2026	Rest or 30-min walk	Mobility + Recovery walk	

WEEK 9		DISTANCE	24 Aug 2026 - 30 Aug 2026
Day	Date	Morning Run	Evening Gym
Day 57 - Mon	24 Aug 2026	Easy - 8 km	Push (Heavy) Chest/Shoulders/Tri
Day 58 - Tue	25 Aug 2026	Steady run - 7 km	Pull (Heavy) Back/Biceps
Day 59 - Wed	26 Aug 2026	Recovery - 5 km	Legs (Moderate)
Day 60 - Thu	27 Aug 2026	Tempo - 6 km	Upper Hypertrophy + Core
Day 61 - Fri	28 Aug 2026	Easy - 8 km	Full Body + Core (lighter)
Day 62 - Sat	29 Aug 2026	Long run - 16 km	Mobility / Stretch (no lifting)
Day 63 - Sun	30 Aug 2026	Rest or 30-min walk	Mobility + Recovery walk

Coach's note

From this week: trim Wed leg-day volume ~20% to protect long-run recovery.

WEEK 10		DISTANCE	31 Aug 2026 - 6 Sep 2026
Day	Date	Morning Run	Evening Gym
Day 64 - Mon	31 Aug 2026	Easy - 9 km	Push (Heavy) Chest/Shoulders/Tri
Day 65 - Tue	1 Sep 2026	Steady run - 7 km	Pull (Heavy) Back/Biceps
Day 66 - Wed	2 Sep 2026	Recovery - 5-6 km	Legs (Moderate)
Day 67 - Thu	3 Sep 2026	Tempo - 7 km	Upper Hypertrophy + Core
Day 68 - Fri	4 Sep 2026	Easy - 9 km	Full Body + Core (lighter)
Day 69 - Sat	5 Sep 2026	Long run - 18 km	Mobility / Stretch (no lifting)
Day 70 - Sun	6 Sep 2026	Rest or 30-min walk	Mobility + Recovery walk

Coach's note

Milestone: your first big distance jump - go out slow.

WEEK 11		DISTANCE		7 Sep 2026 - 13 Sep 2026	
Day	Date	Morning Run		Evening Gym	
Day 71 - Mon	7 Sep 2026	Easy - 9 km		Push (Heavy) Chest/Shoulders/Tri	
Day 72 - Tue	8 Sep 2026	Steady run - 7 km		Pull (Heavy) Back/Biceps	
Day 73 - Wed	9 Sep 2026	Recovery - 6 km		Legs (Moderate)	
Day 74 - Thu	10 Sep 2026	Tempo - 7 km		Upper Hypertrophy + Core	
Day 75 - Fri	11 Sep 2026	Easy - 9 km		Full Body + Core (lighter)	
Day 76 - Sat	12 Sep 2026	Long run - 20 km		Mobility / Stretch (no lifting)	
Day 77 - Sun	13 Sep 2026	Rest or 30-min walk		Mobility + Recovery walk	

WEEK 12		DISTANCE		14 Sep 2026 - 20 Sep 2026	
Day	Date	Morning Run		Evening Gym	
Day 78 - Mon	14 Sep 2026	Easy - 10 km		Push (Heavy) Chest/Shoulders/Tri	
Day 79 - Tue	15 Sep 2026	Steady run - 8 km		Pull (Heavy) Back/Biceps	
Day 80 - Wed	16 Sep 2026	Recovery - 6 km		Legs (Moderate)	
Day 81 - Thu	17 Sep 2026	Tempo - 8 km		Upper Hypertrophy + Core	
Day 82 - Fri	18 Sep 2026	Easy - 9-10 km		Full Body + Core (lighter)	
Day 83 - Sat	19 Sep 2026	Long run - 22 km		Mobility / Stretch (no lifting)	
Day 84 - Sun	20 Sep 2026	Rest or 30-min walk		Mobility + Recovery walk	

WEEK 13		PEAK	21 Sep 2026 - 27 Sep 2026	
Day	Date	Morning Run	Evening Gym	
Day 85 - Mon	21 Sep 2026	Easy - 8 km (cutback)	Push (Heavy) Chest/Shoulders/Tri	
Day 86 - Tue	22 Sep 2026	Steady run - 6 km	Pull (Heavy) Back/Biceps	
Day 87 - Wed	23 Sep 2026	Recovery - 5 km	Legs (Moderate)	
Day 88 - Thu	24 Sep 2026	Tempo - 6 km	Upper Hypertrophy + Core	
Day 89 - Fri	25 Sep 2026	Easy - 7 km	Full Body + Core (lighter)	
Day 90 - Sat	26 Sep 2026	Long run - 26 km	Mobility / Stretch (no lifting)	
Day 91 - Sun	27 Sep 2026	Rest - full recovery	Mobility + Recovery walk	

Coach's note

PEAK WEEK & decision point - see Race-Day Strategy. Reduce all gym volume ~30-40%.

WEEK 14		TAPER	28 Sep 2026 - 4 Oct 2026	
Day	Date	Morning Run	Evening Gym	
Day 92 - Mon	28 Sep 2026	Easy - 6 km	Push (Heavy) Chest/Shoulders/Tri	
Day 93 - Tue	29 Sep 2026	Easy w/ strides - 5 km	Pull (Heavy) Back/Biceps	
Day 94 - Wed	30 Sep 2026	Recovery - 4 km	Legs (Moderate)	
Day 95 - Thu	1 Oct 2026	Easy - 4 km	Upper Hypertrophy + Core	
Day 96 - Fri	2 Oct 2026	Easy - 3 km	Full Body + Core (lighter)	
Day 97 - Sat	3 Oct 2026	Long run (taper) - 16 km	Mobility / Stretch (no lifting)	
Day 98 - Sun	4 Oct 2026	Rest - full recovery	Mobility + Recovery walk	

Coach's note

Taper: same gym exercises, lighter loads, longer rest between sets.

Day	Date	Plan	Gym
Day 99 - Mon	5 Oct 2026	Rest, or 15-min easy jog. Lay out race kit, hydrate, carb-focused meals.	Light mobility only
Day 100 - Tue	6 Oct 2026	RACE DAY - Marathon or Half-Marathon (see Race-Day Strategy)	-

PART 3 THE GYM PROGRAM

9. Training Philosophy in the Gym

Five sessions a week, every week: two heavy days (Push, Pull) for strength and muscle, one moderate leg day kept deliberately lighter than you could lift so your legs stay fresh for running, one hypertrophy day for upper-body shape and core, and one lighter full-body day with higher reps. Rest 60-120 seconds between sets unless noted. Add small amounts of weight whenever you can complete every rep with good form - that progressive overload is what builds the muscle while the running builds the engine.

Two rules that matter more than the exercises

1) Never lift legs heavy the day before a tempo run or the long run - Wednesday's leg session is capped at a moderate effort on purpose. 2) From Week 9 onward, trim leg-day volume by about 20%, and in Week 13 (peak week) trim every session by 30-40%. Recovery capacity is finite; the long run gets priority.

9.1. Monday - Push (Heavy)

Chest / Shoulders / Triceps

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest	Notes
Barbell Bench Press	4 x 6-8	2 min	Main lift - add weight when all reps feel solid
Incline Dumbbell Press	3 x 8-10	90s	
Seated Overhead Press	3 x 8-10	90s	
Weighted Dips	3 x 10-12	60s	Bodyweight dips if weighted feels too heavy
Cable Triceps Pushdown	3 x 12-15	60s	
Lateral Raise	3 x 15-20	45s	Light weight, strict form - for shoulder width

9.2. Tuesday - Pull (Heavy)

Back / Biceps

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest	Notes
Pull-ups (or Lat Pulldown)	4 x 6-10	2 min	Use assistance/lat pulldown if needed
Barbell Row	4 x 8	90s	
Seated Cable Row	3 x 10-12	90s	
Face Pull	3 x 15	60s	Posture and shoulder health, especially with all the running
Barbell / EZ-Bar Curl	3 x 10	60s	
Hammer Curl	3 x 12	45s	

9.3. Wednesday - Legs (Moderate)

Deliberately lighter than max effort - tomorrow has a tempo run

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest	Notes
Back Squat or Goblet Squat	3 x 10	90s	RPE 7/10 - stop two reps short of failure
Romanian Deadlift	3 x 10	90s	
Leg Press	3 x 12	75s	
Walking Lunge	2 x 12 / leg	60s	
Standing Calf Raise	3 x 15	45s	

Note

From Week 9: drop one set from Squat and Leg Press. In Week 13 (peak week), do this session at ~60% of normal volume.

9.4. Thursday - Upper Body Hypertrophy + Core

Pump-focused, higher reps, shorter rest

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest	Notes
Incline Dumbbell Press	3 x 12	60s	
Lat Pulldown	3 x 12	60s	
Seated DB Shoulder Press	3 x 12	60s	
Cable Fly	3 x 15	45s	
Plank	3 x 45-60s	45s	
Hanging Leg Raise	3 x 12	45s	Lower with control - don't swing

9.5. Friday - Full Body + Core

Lighter loads, higher reps - this session should leave you fresh, not wrecked

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest	Notes
Goblet Squat	3 x 15	60s	
Push-up	3 x 15	45s	Add weight on back, or elevate feet, once easy
Dumbbell Row	3 x 15	60s	
Glute Bridge	3 x 15	45s	
Cable Crunch	3 x 15	45s	
Farmer's Carry	3 x 30 m	60s	Heavy dumbbells/kettlebells, walk tall

9.6 Saturday & Sunday

Saturday evening: stretching only - no lifting, your legs just did the long run. Sunday: mobility work (hips, ankles, shoulders) plus an optional 30-minute easy walk. See Part 5 for the full mobility routine.

PART 4 NUTRITION

10. Macro Targets

You're running most days and lifting heavy four times a week, so this is not a calorie-deficit plan - a large deficit alongside this training load is how people lose the muscle they're trying to build and run on empty. Aim for roughly 2,600-2,750 kcal/day on running + heavy-lifting days, and toward the lower end on Sunday's rest day.

Macro	Daily target	Why
Protein	170-180 g	Repairs muscle from both lifting and running impact
Carbohydrates	300-350 g	Fuels long runs and heavy lifting; under-fuelling here kills both
Fat	65-80 g	Hormones, joint health, satiety

Long-run days

Add an extra 200-400 kcal, mostly carbohydrate, on Saturdays once the long run passes 14-16 km - this is not the day to under-eat.

11. Sample Meal Plans

11.1 Non-veg days (Monday, Thursday, Friday, Saturday, Sunday)

Meal	Plan
Breakfast	Oats cooked in milk + 2-3 whole eggs + 1 banana
Lunch	Rice or roti + grilled/curry chicken (150-200g) + mixed vegetables + salad
Pre-gym snack	Greek yogurt + 1 banana (or a small whey shake)
Dinner	Chicken or fish (150-200g) + rice or sweet potato + vegetables
Post-gym (optional)	Whey protein shake if dinner is more than ~45 min away

11.2 Vegetarian days, no eggs (Tuesday & Wednesday)

Same macro targets, different protein sources - paneer, tofu, soy chunks, lentils, chickpeas, kidney beans (rajma), milk, curd/Greek yogurt and whey protein all stack up quickly if you eat generous portions at each meal.

Meal	Plan
Breakfast	Oats cooked in milk + whey or a handful of nuts + 1 banana
Lunch	Rice or roti + paneer/tofu or rajma-chole + mixed vegetables + curd
Pre-gym snack	Greek yogurt + banana, or roasted soy chunks
Dinner	Dal (generous portion) + paneer or tofu + roti/rice + vegetables + salad

Hitting 170-180g protein without eggs or meat

100g paneer ~18g protein - 100g tofu ~12g - 1 cup cooked rajma/chole ~15g - 1 cup milk ~8g - 1 scoop whey ~24g - 1 cup Greek yogurt ~17g. Two solid meals plus one whey shake on Tue/Wed comfortably covers the target.

12. Five Recipes That Make This Easy

High-Protein Masala Oats

Ingredients: Oats, milk, finely chopped onion/tomato, a spoon of paneer crumbled in, turmeric, cumin, salt.

Method: Cook oats in milk on low heat; stir in sauteed onion-tomato-spice mix and crumbled paneer in the last 2 minutes.

Grilled Chicken & Rice Bowl

Ingredients: Chicken breast, rice, mixed vegetables, garlic, black pepper, a little oil.

Method: Marinate chicken in garlic, pepper, a pinch of salt; grill or pan-sear. Serve over rice with steamed or stir-fried vegetables.

Paneer Bhurji (no egg)

Ingredients: Paneer, onion, tomato, green chilli, turmeric, cumin, coriander leaves.

Method: Crumble paneer. Sweat onion, tomato and spices in a pan, fold in paneer for 2-3 minutes, finish with coriander.

Soy Chunk Curry

Ingredients: Soy chunks (rehydrated), onion-tomato gravy, standard curry spices, rice or roti.

Method: Boil soy chunks 5 minutes, squeeze dry. Simmer in onion-tomato gravy with spices for 10-12 minutes; serve with rice.

Post-Run Recovery Shake

Ingredients: Milk, 1 banana, 1 scoop whey, a spoon of peanut butter.

Method: Blend everything until smooth. Drink within an hour of a long run or a heavy lift session.

13. Weekly Grocery List

Proteins	Carbs & produce	Fats & pantry
Chicken breast	Oats	Peanut butter
Fish (your choice)	Rice	Mixed nuts
Eggs	Roti / atta	Olive oil / ghee
Paneer	Sweet potato	Turmeric, cumin, coriander, garam masala
Tofu	Bananas	Salt, black pepper
Soy chunks	Mixed seasonal fruit	Green chilli
Lentils (dal)	Mixed vegetables	
Chickpeas / rajma	Onion, tomato, garlic, ginger	
Whey protein	Leafy greens	
Greek yogurt / curd		
Milk		

14. Hydration

Situation	Guidance
Baseline	3-4 litres of water across the day, sipped steadily rather than all at once
Long run / hot weather	Add 500 ml-1 L on top of baseline; carry water once a run passes ~9-10 km
Runs over 60 minutes	Add electrolytes (a pinch of salt + lemon, or an electrolyte mix) - water alone isn't enough
Quick self-check	Pale yellow urine = well hydrated. Dark yellow = drink more, especially before a long run

PART 5 RECOVERY & RACE DAY

15. Stretching & Mobility

15.1 After every run (5-7 minutes)

- Calf stretch against a wall - 30s each side
- Standing quad stretch - 30s each side
- Standing hamstring stretch (foot on a step) - 30s each side
- Kneeling hip-flexor stretch - 30s each side
- Figure-4 glute/IT-band stretch (lying down) - 30s each side

15.2 After lifting

- Doorway chest stretch - 30s each side
- Overhead triceps stretch - 30s each side
- Cross-body shoulder stretch - 30s each side
- Lat stretch holding a rack or door frame - 30s each side

15.3 Foam rolling - 2-3x per week

60-90 seconds each on calves, quads, IT band (outer thigh) and glutes. It should feel like firm pressure, not sharp pain.

15.4 Sunday mobility flow

- Hip circles - 10 each direction, each leg
- Ankle circles - 10 each direction, each foot
- Cat-cow - 10 slow reps
- World's greatest stretch - 5 reps each side
- Thoracic (mid-back) rotations - 10 each side

16. Injury Prevention

Almost every running injury on a plan like this is an overuse injury - it builds slowly rather than happening in one moment. Knowing the early warning signs of the common ones means you can back off for 3-4 days instead of 3-4 weeks.

Watch for	Often means
Pain on the outer shin during/after running	Shin splints - usually from too much, too soon
Dull ache around/behind the kneecap	Runner's knee - often linked to weak hips/glutes
Sharp pain on the outer knee/thigh	IT band irritation
Stabbing heel pain, worst with first steps in the morning	Plantar fasciitis
Pain/stiffness at the back of the ankle	Achilles tendinitis

General prevention checklist

Replace running shoes every ~500-600 km.

Increase distance gradually - this plan already does that; don't add extra km on top of it.

Keep doing the Wednesday/Friday strength work - strong hips and glutes prevent most of the list above.

Warm up with 5 minutes of easy jogging before any interval or tempo session.

Red flags - stop and see a doctor or physiotherapist

Pain that is sharp, one-sided, or changes how you walk.

Pain that gets worse during a run instead of warming up and easing.

Any pain that hasn't improved after 3-4 days of rest.

Visible swelling.

17. Sleep

7.5-8 hours, every night, is doing as much work as any single session in this plan - it's when muscle actually repairs and when a lot of running-injury risk is determined. The daily schedule in Part 1 builds in screens-off at 9:45 PM and lights-out at 10:00 PM on purpose; protect that especially the night before Tuesday intervals and Saturday's long run.

18. Race-Day Strategy

18.1 The decision point - Week 13

After the 26 km long run in Week 13, be honest with yourself using three questions: Did it feel hard but manageable, or did it hurt? Were you back to normal walking/movement within 2-3 days? Did the rest of that week's training go ahead as planned? If yes to all three, the full marathon with a run/walk strategy is a reasonable target. If any answer is concerning - especially ongoing pain - shift the target to the half marathon for this cycle. That is not a failure; finishing a half marathon from a 2 km start in 100 days, with visible muscle gained along the way, is a genuinely strong result, and a full marathon can follow later from a much higher base.

If in doubt

Talk to a doctor or physiotherapist before race day if anything from Week 13 onward felt off. This guide can plan your training; it can't examine your knee.

18.2 Pacing

Distance	Pacing approach
Half marathon	Start 20-30 sec/km slower than feels 'right' - most first-timers go out too fast. Settle into rhythm by 3-4 km.
Full marathon	Start even slower than that. Treat the first 30 km as one steady effort, then use a run/walk pattern (e.g., run 8 min / walk 1 min) for the final 12 km if needed - this is a standard, effective first-marathon strategy, not a compromise.

18.3 Fuelling during the race

- Half marathon: water/electrolytes at aid stations; a gel after ~10 km if you've practised it in training.
- Full marathon: 30-60 g carbohydrate per hour from gels or sports drink, starting around 45-60 minutes in - practise this exact fuelling on at least 2 long training runs beforehand, never for the first time on race day.
- Hydrate at every aid station, small sips rather than gulping.

18.4 Morning-of checklist

- Lay out kit, bib, and fuel the night before.
- Eat a familiar carb-heavy breakfast 2-3 hours before the start.
- Arrive with enough time for a 10-minute easy jog + dynamic stretches as a warm-up.
- Anti-chafe balm on underarms, inner thighs, and anywhere your kit has rubbed in training.
- Watch/phone charged, route/aid-station plan reviewed.

One more thing

You will have done 99 days of work before the gun even goes off. Whatever happens on the day, that part is already a win.

PART 6 TRACKERS & MILESTONES

19. Weight & Body Composition Log

Weigh yourself once a week, same day and time (ideally Sunday morning, fasted). Trends matter far more than any single number.

Week	Date	Weight (kg)	Body Fat %	Notes
Week 1				
Week 2				
Week 3				
Week 4				
Week 5				
Week 6				
Week 7				
Week 8				
Week 9				
Week 10				
Week 11				
Week 12				
Week 13				
Week 14				

20. Running Pace Log

Log every Tuesday interval session and every Saturday long run at minimum - that's enough to see real progress.

Date	Run type	Distance	Time	Pace /km	RPE (1-10)

21. Gym PR Tracker

Record your best working weight x reps at each checkpoint - the goal is for every column to beat the last.

Lift	Week 1	Week 4	Week 8	Week 12
Barbell Bench Press				
Seated Overhead Press				
Barbell Row				
Pull-ups (max reps)				
Back Squat				
Romanian Deadlift				

22. Weekly Habit Tracker

Reuse this same grid every week (photocopy it, redraw it, or recreate it in a notes app) - tick off each day.

Habit	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Slept 7.5h+							
Hit protein target							
Drank 3L+ water							
Did the day's run							
Did the day's lift							
Stretched / mobility							

23. Milestone Check-Ins

Four points to pause, log your numbers honestly, and look back at how far you've actually come.

Day 25 - One Quarter Down (23 Jul 2026)

Log	Value
Weight (kg)	
Body fat %	
Longest run to date	
Best Bench Press	
Best Squat	

How do you feel - physically and mentally?

What's improved the most since the last check-in?

What's been hardest?

Where you are

Foundation and base-building are done. The hardest adaptation - turning into someone who runs regularly - is largely behind you.

Day 50 - Halfway (17 Aug 2026)

Log	Value
Weight (kg)	
Body fat %	
Longest run to date	
Best Bench Press	
Best Squat	

How do you feel - physically and mentally?

What's improved the most since the last check-in?

What's been hardest?

Where you are

You're deep into the endurance phase. Long runs are now genuinely long. This is usually where motivation dips hardest - the habit tracker matters most right here.

Day 75 - Three Quarters (11 Sep 2026)

Log	Value
Weight (kg)	
Body fat %	
Longest run to date	
Best Bench Press	
Best Squat	

How do you feel - physically and mentally?

What's improved the most since the last check-in?

What's been hardest?

Where you are

You're in or just past the Distance phase, closing in on the Week-13 decision point. Trust the taper that follows - more mileage now is not better.

Day 100 - Race Day (6 Oct 2026)

Log	Value
Weight (kg)	
Body fat %	
Longest run to date	
Best Bench Press	
Best Squat	

How do you feel - physically and mentally?

What's improved the most since the last check-in?

What's been hardest?

Where you are

100 days ago you could run 2 km with real effort. Whatever the official result today, that gap is the real achievement - log it, then go celebrate properly.

A CLOSING NOTE

Plans on paper are easy; the version of this that matters is the one you actually run, lift and eat through for 100 days. You won't hit every session exactly as written, and that's fine - what predicts the outcome on race day is the trend across 14 weeks, not any single day. Come back to the calendar in Part 2 whenever a day feels uncertain, trust the taper when it arrives, and use the decision point in Week 13 honestly rather than heroically.

Good luck, Shivam. See you at the start line.